Gender Boxes

By Macklemore and Ryan Lewis, Bradley Hathaway and Andrea Gibson

Same Love by Macklemore and Ryan Lewis
(Song Lyrics)

When I was in the 3rd grade I thought that I was gay 'cause
I could draw
My uncle was and I kept my room straight
I told my mom, tears rushing down my face, she's like
"Ben you've loved girls since before pre-K"
Trippin', yeah, I guess she had a point, didn't she?
A bunch of stereotypes all in my head
I remember doing the math like "Yeah, I'm good a little
league"
A pre-conceived idea of what it all meant
For those who like the same sex had the [same]
characteristics . . .

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Macklemore and Ryan Lewis
Book: From the Album "The Heist" (Track 5)
ISBN: N/A (Song Lyrics)
Publisher: Macklemore/RyanLewis Studios, Seattle, WA
Date (Month/Year): 2012

Lyrics can be found on-line at
https://genius.com/Macklemore-and-ryan-lewis-same-love-lyrics

INTRODUCTION

Why are creative, expressive boys are labeled by our society as potentially gay? Or girls who would rather play with GI Joe than Barbie draw disapproving looks for being less than feminine. Ugh! I'm so tired of the Gay/Straight labeling. Every day people are forced to limit their individuality to fit into society's gender stereotypes. To limit their masculinity or their femininity because of what people might think or say. It's time to rip the lids from these . . .

Gender Boxes – a program including Same Love by Macklemore and Ryan Lewis, Manly Man by Bradley Hathaway and Swing-Set by Andrea Gibson

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Manly Man by Bradley Hathaway

I don't want my long hair
pretty green eyes with
no I do not have on mascara
Eyelashes
Skinny figure
Undersized T-shirt

Hips
Shake
Too
Much
when I walk
Confuse anybody . . .

I am a Manly Man!

Within this sissy frame
obviously rib laden chest
lies a heart
that beats
to the drum of a
Native American ritual dancing

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wildness

It pumps an ever-cascading supply of untamedness
that a herd of wild mustangs have yet to grasp.

If danger lurks about, I will seek it out.
If adventure abounds, there I will be found.
If a damsel be in distress

I will show her who is best.

I am a Manly Man!

Because I don't flush
and I leave the lid up.
Girls don't break up with me
I break up with them first!

I don't shave the hair on my face
(because I still can't grow facial hair yet, but when I can I won't.)
Because beards are tough.

I fart
burp
spit
when I want

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Not caring who's nearby

Disrespect my momma

and I will punch you in the eye!

I am a Manly Man!

Or am I?

I tell my guy friends that I love them.

And sometimes, sometimes, I even hug them.

No because I'm not gay. But because I love em'.

And when people talk

I try to listen

a spirit of compassion

That's my vision.

Surely I am a Manly Man

I want to be loved

and have love

and give Love.

Although I am looking for that beauty

Not helpless

But wants to be rescued.

The Damsel in distress

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Man

Woman

Myth

True.

I will fight for her.

Climb the highest tower for her

Love her.

Share with her.

Delight in her.

Be her warrior.

Her protector.

She will be my crown

and I will be hers.

My Masculinity will be passed down

and affirmed to my sons.

Each of my daughters will know they are lovely

and deserving of authentic romance.

Society tells me all day long

That I have defined manhood completely wrong.

But you ask any honest man and he will agree

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You ask any honest woman and she too will see

That I am a Manly Man!

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Brian Hathaway
Book: All the Hits So Far But Don't Expect Too Much . . .
ISBN: 978-0976364238
Publisher: Relevant Books
Date (Month/Year): Aug 2005

TRANSITION

The final poem comes to us from the perspective of a female kindergarten teacher who has a powerful lesson that we all need to learn. Swing-set by Andrea Gibson.

Swing-set by Andrea Gibson

"Are you a boy or a girl?"
he asks, staring up at me in all three feet of his pudding
face grandeur, and I say "Dylan,
you've been in this class for three years and you still don't
know if I'm a boy or a girl?"
"Uh-uh."
"Well, at this point, I don't really think it matters, do you?"
"Uhm, no.

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Can I have a push on the swing?"
And this happens every day.
It's a tidal wave of kindergarten curiosity rushing straight
for the rocks of me, whatever I am.

In the class, when we discuss the Milky Way galaxy, the
orbit of the Sun around the Earth or whatever.
Jupiter, Saturn, Mars, and kids, do you know that some of
the stars we see when we look up in the sky are so far
away, they've already burned out?
What do you think of that?
Timmy?
"Uh my mom says that even though you got hairs that grow
from your legs, and the hairs on your head grow short and
poky, and that you smell really bad, like my dad, that you're
a girl."
"Thank you, Timmy."
And so it goes.

On the playground, she peers up at me from behind her
pink power puff sunglasses and then asks, "Do you have a
boyfriend?"

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And I say no, and she says “Oh… do you have a girlfriend?”
And I say “No, but if by some miracle, twenty years from now, I ever finally do, then I’ll definitely bring her by to meet you. How’s that?”
“Okay. Can I have a push on the swing?”
And that’s the thing.
They don’t care.
They don’t care. Us, on the other hand.
My father sitting across the table at Christmas dinner, gritting his teeth over his still-full plate, his appetite raped away by the intrusion of my haircut,
“What were you thinking? You used to be such a pretty girl!”
Frat boys, drunken, screaming, leaning out of the windows of their daddys’ SUVs,
“Hey! Are you a faggot or a dyke?”
And I wonder what would happen if I met up with them in the middle of the night.

Then of course there’s always the somehow not-quite-bright enough fluorescent light of the public restroom, “Sir!

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Sir, do you realize this is the ladies’ room?”
“Yes, ma’am, I do . . . “

But the best, the best is always the mother at the market, sticking up her nose while pushing aside her daughter’s wide eyes, whispering “Don’t stare, it’s rude.”
And I want to say, “Listen, lady, the only rude thing I see is your paranoid parental hand pushing aside the best education on self that little girl’s ever gonna get, living with your Maybelline lipstick after hips and pedi kiwi, vanilla-smelling beauty;
so why don’t you take your pinks and blues, your boy-girl rules and shove them in that car with your issue of Cosmo, because tomorrow, I start my day with twenty-eight minds who know a lot more than you.
And if I show up in a pink frilly dress, those kids won’t love me any more, or less.”

“Hey, are you a boy or a — never mind, can I have a push on the swing?”
And some day, y’all, when we grow up, it’s all gonna be that simple.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Andrea Gibson
Book: Pole Dancing to Gospel Hymns
ISBN: 978-0981521305
Publisher: Write Bloody Publishing
Date (Month/Year): June 2008

AWARD HISTORY

NE State Qualifier

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